MB-BKY-001

Partner Bakery Standard

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Morning Box - Your Personal Breakfast Assistant

Purpose

This standard defines the minimum eligibility, product, safety, preparation, packaging, capacity, fulfilment, quality, performance and commercial principles required for Morning Box Partner Bakeries in the MVP.

Core Partner Principle

> **Partner bakeries may have their own character. Morning Box must have one consistent standard.**

1. Partner Bakery Eligibility

A Morning Box Partner Bakery must be an appropriately licensed food business and must meet Morning Box minimum operating requirements. Every Partner Bakery must bake its own bread in-house, be capable of producing the required Morning Box Core Products to specification, maintain suitable food-safety capability, have practical morning production capacity, and support the minimum operational flow: Receive Order -> Confirm -> Prepare -> Mark Ready -> Handover.

Morning Box distinguishes Partner Eligibility from Order Eligibility. A bakery may be an approved network partner while remaining ineligible for a particular order because of product availability, dietary/allergy capability, capacity or delivery-window constraints.

> **Partner Eligibility does not automatically mean Order Eligibility.**

2. Product & Ingredient Compliance

Morning Box owns the product specification for its approved breakfast models and components. Specifications may define ingredients, portion, relevant preparation requirements, presentation, packaging and other outcome-critical standards. Morning Box should standardize the customer outcome without unnecessarily micro-managing every kitchen movement.

Unauthorized substitution is not permitted. If an ingredient or item is unavailable, the bakery must report availability rather than independently replace it. Morning Box may define minimum ingredient-quality requirements without requiring every bakery to use the same supplier or brand.

Portion consistency is mandatory across partners. The locked rule remains: Size changes quantity, not composition. Only items in the Morning Box Approved Product Library may be fulfilled through Morning Box.

> **Different bakeries may prepare Morning Box. The customer should still receive the same Morning Box standard.**

3. Food Safety, Dietary Requirements & Allergy Capability

Dietary requirements and allergies must be treated distinctly. Dietary requirements act as eligibility filters. Allergies are hard safety filters: incompatible products must not appear in Recommendation, Swap or Add-ons, and the allocated bakery must be eligible to handle the relevant order.

The safety sequence is User Safety Filter -> Product Eligibility -> Bakery Eligibility. Each Partner Bakery maintains a capability profile for relevant requirements such as nuts, dairy, eggs and gluten. A capability is marked supported only when the bakery has an acceptable handling process for reducing cross-contact risk.

Morning Box must not make unsupported claims such as '100% Allergy Safe'. Allergy-related orders require clear production and packaging identification. If a bakery is uncertain about ingredients, cross-contact or its ability to fulfil a safety requirement, it must not accept the order.

> **When safety is uncertain, the order should not be allocated.**

4. Freshness & Preparation Standard

Morning Box breakfasts must be prepared for the scheduled morning. Appropriate advance preparation of safe base ingredients may occur where operationally normal, but final preparation and assembly should happen as close as practical to the assigned Ready-by Time.

Morning Box assigns Ready-by times based on delivery windows and routing rather than requiring all orders to be completed at one early time. Hot and cold components must be assembled and packaged so that one does not materially reduce the quality or safety of the other.

Before handover, the bakery checks: Correct Order, Correct Components, Correct Size, Correct Add-ons, Dietary/Allergy Identification and Packaging Condition. Exact temperature and holding specifications are deferred to detailed Production & Food Safety Specifications.

> **Prepare as late as practical. Deliver as fresh as possible.**

5. Packaging & Morning Box Identification

Primary food packaging is provided by the Partner Bakery and may retain the bakery's own branding. Morning Box does not require expensive fully bespoke packaging for MVP and does not obscure the identity of the food-preparing bakery.

A standardized Morning Box label or sticker identifies the order and may include Morning Box, Order ID, breakfast identification, Size and relevant Dietary/Allergy indicators. Each individual Business Breakfast box must remain identifiable, especially where sizes or Special Breakfast requirements differ.

Packaging must protect against leakage, crushing, tipping and presentation damage, and must support appropriate separation where required. Morning Box adopts the principle of avoiding unnecessary packaging; specific sustainability-material mandates are deferred until cost and supplier options are validated.

> **The bakery remains visible. Morning Box makes the order identifiable and consistent.**

6. Production Capacity & Availability

Each Partner Bakery must maintain realistic Morning Box capacity and availability. Capacity may depend on general production, Special/Dietary capability, product availability and Ready-by timing, rather than simply a total number of boxes.

The bakery must be able to report temporary conditions such as Item Unavailable, Reduced Capacity, Special Requirement Unavailable or Temporarily Unavailable before affected orders are allocated. Once effective capacity is reached, Morning Box routes additional eligible orders elsewhere.

Morning Box may set an effective allocation capacity below the bakery's stated maximum when actual performance data indicates that a lower level better protects service quality.

> **Capacity is what can be delivered to Morning Box standard - not simply what the bakery can produce.**

7. Order Acceptance, Availability Changes & Fulfilment

An allocated order must be either Accepted or marked Unable to Fulfil with a defined operational reason, such as product unavailability, capacity, dietary/allergy limitation or equipment/operational failure.

Acceptance creates a production commitment. Availability changes should be reported before orders are affected. After acceptance, the bakery may not independently replace ingredients, change Size, remove components or alter Add-ons. Any issue follows Report Issue -> Morning Box decides the resolution.

The operational bakery status flow is Allocated -> Accepted -> In Preparation -> Ready -> Handed Over. Repeated rejection of orders that were allocated according to the bakery's own declared capability may negatively affect Partner Performance.

> **Keep availability accurate. Accept only what you can fulfil. Once accepted, deliver the standard.**

8. Quality Control & Product Consistency

Every Morning Box breakfast model and component should have an approved specification covering the outcome-critical elements of ingredients, portion, preparation, presentation and packaging.

Before going live, a Partner Bakery completes onboarding sample production so Morning Box can assess taste and quality, portion accuracy, appearance, packaging, delivery suitability and consistency. Approval may be product-specific: a bakery may be approved for some Morning Box products and not others.

Quality continues after onboarding through periodic checks, sample orders and customer feedback. Minor natural differences between bakeries are acceptable, but the defined Morning Box composition, portion, ingredient and quality standards must remain consistent.

> **Partner bakeries may have their own character. Morning Box must have one consistent standard.**

9. Partner Performance Monitoring

MVP Partner Performance is measured through a small set of operationally useful indicators: Order Accuracy, Ready-on-Time Rate, Product Quality & Consistency, Fulfilment Reliability, and Customer Feedback.

Ready-on-Time is measured against the bakery's Ready-by Time and is kept distinct from courier delivery punctuality. Fulfilment Reliability includes inappropriate rejections, cancellations after acceptance, unreported unavailable items and other bakery-caused failures.

These indicators are for backend allocation and partner management. Morning Box does not expose public bakery ratings that would move the product toward a marketplace. In the future, performance may become an input to a Best Available Bakery allocation model.

> **Measure partner performance to improve fulfilment - not to create a bakery marketplace.**

10. Partner Status, Warning & Corrective Action

Partner operational status may be Active, Under Review, or Suspended. Repeated issues such as low accuracy, late readiness, poor product quality, rejection after acceptance, unauthorized substitution, packaging failure or recurring complaints may trigger review or operational limits.

Serious food-safety or allergy incidents may trigger immediate review or suspension where appropriate. When a problem is correctable, the process is Identify Issue -> Corrective Action -> Verification -> Return to Active.

Numeric performance thresholds are intentionally deferred until DIFC pilot data establishes realistic baselines.

> **Protect the Morning Box standard first. Help the partner improve where possible.**

11. Commercial Relationship & Settlement Principles

The customer places and pays for the order through Morning Box. The Partner Bakery is the food-fulfilment partner responsible for food preparation, primary packaging and handover. Morning Box manages the ordering experience, personalization, allocation and coordination, while the delivery partner manages last-mile delivery.

Morning Box receives customer payment and settles with the bakery through a pre-agreed backend commercial structure. Commission percentages, bakery payouts, settlement cycles, delivery-cost sharing and discount funding are deferred to the Commercial Agreement / Financial Model.

The bakery must know the agreed payout or price schedule for Morning Box products, sizes and approved add-ons before operating. Customer promotions or Business Volume Discounts do not automatically become a bakery cost unless this has been agreed in advance.

Morning Box-generated customer relationships should not be diverted outside the Morning Box ecosystem using order data. This does not hide the bakery's identity; after allocation, the customer may see Prepared by [Partner Bakery].

> **Morning Box owns the ordering relationship. The bakery owns food preparation. Each partner is paid according to a clear pre-agreed commercial structure.**

MVP Deferred Details

Detailed recipe sheets, exact gram/unit portions, product-specific temperature and holding limits, partner KPI thresholds, commission rates, settlement cycles and commercial discount funding are intentionally deferred to later production, food-safety and commercial specifications.

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